

In this section, we'll be showing you how to build up your own media server, using your old unused PC. We'll also show you a cool feature that comes with Windows 7, which encapsulates what Media Servers are all about.

Building your very own media server

While the market is now being flooded by computer manufacturers coming out with “media servers” to sell to consumers, it's important to know that you don't have to necessarily buy a brand new machine. Instead, you can use cheap (or salvaged) parts to build your own box, as media server hardware doesn't have to be top-notch.

You may have one or two old computers hanging around the house, in a corner, in a basement, attic, etc. just collecting dust. We'll now show you how to build home media servers from this old junk of a computer. Note here that in this short tutorial, we're assuming you have XP running on your old computer. But it should work equally well with any Windows OS.

1. Start by clicking “Start” and “Control Panel.”
2. Select “Network Setup Wizard.”
3. Press “Next” two times and then select “This computer connects to the internet thorough a residential...” and then select “Next.”
4. Enter a name and description for your server and then click “Next.”
5. In the next window, select the workgroup name and then click “Next.”
6. Now, select the “Turn on Windows File and Printer Sharing” option and click “Next.”



Choosing the
Network Setup
Wizard from the
Control Panel